PRESERVING EVERY DROP

HOW PEPSICO INDIA IS TRANSFORMING WATER CONSERVATION IN RURAL COMMUNITIES



safe drinking water infrastructure for students in a Sirthala school (Kosi)

Water: The Lifeline We Must Protect

Water is the essence of life—nourishing ecosystems, sustaining agriculture, and shaping the well-being of communities. Yet, with depleting groundwater levels and increasing water stress, especially in rural India, the need for effective water conservation has never been more urgent. As the world comes together to observe World Water Day 2025, it serves as a reminder that sustainable water management is not just an environmental imperative but a fundamental necessity for future generations.

Recognizing this, PepsiCo India, under its "Partnership of Progress" philosophy, has been actively working towards strengthening water security. By working with local communities and experts, the company is driving water conservation efforts that directly impact those who heavily rely on it today.

A Region in Need: The Water Crisis in Hathras

Hathras, like many parts of Uttar Pradesh, has been facing a severe water crisis. Groundwater levels have been steadily declining and with erratic rainfall patterns.

The Watershed Health Initiative: A Sustainable Model for Change

To tackle the pressing water crisis in Hathras, PepsiCo India, in collaboration with FORCE Trust, launched the Watershed Health Initiative. Through a combination of rainwater harvesting, pond rejuvenation, and well restoration, communities now have improved access to water for irrigation and daily needs.



Residents use the restored well with clean water access in a village in Kosi

The impact of the Watershed Health Initiative goes beyond numbers—it's about real change in people's lives. Through rainwater harvesting and efficient water management, the initiative has helped conserve 8.12 crore liters of water annually, ensuring long-term water availability for farming and daily use. More than 2,300 farming families have directly benefited.

The establishment of 45 water-efficient farms has improved irrigation techniques; soil management have significantly reduced water consumption while boosting crop yields. Farmers who once struggled with unpredictable water supply now speak of a renewed sense of security.

Shri Birendra Singh Rana, Hon'ble MLA of Sikandra Rao, lauded the effort, calling it "a crucial step towards sustainable rural development. Groundwater conservation is key to securing the future of agriculture, and this model can inspire similar transformations across the region."

Yashika Singh, Chief Corporate Affairs Officer & Sustainability Head, PepsiCo India, emphasized, "we believe that true progress is built on collective action. We are working hand-in-hand with communities to develop scalable water solutions that have a lasting impact."

Voices from the Ground in Kosi, A Community Transformed

The Kosi Kalan region of Mathura has long faced water scarcity due to high salinity in groundwater. PepsiCo Foundation and FORCE Trust partnered to implement a holistic program; through the construction of rainwater harvesting systems, RO units, pond rejuvenation, and wells construction and restoration, 13 villages now have access to safe drinking water.

Schools in Sirthala and Mehrana have seen increased attendance of students, as a result of installation of RO systems ensuring safe drinking water, construction of toilets and rainwater harvesting structures and awareness among students on water usage, hygiene and sanitation.

Bagjeet Singh, Village Pradhan of Mehrana, shared, "Many villagers were leaving the area due to the lack of drinking water. We had to spend a lot of money every month to arrange drinking water through water tankers. The transformation driven by PepsiCo Foundation and FORCE Trust in partnership with our community, has brought a lot of joy for the villages in Mehrana and nearby."

The Vision Ahead: A Blueprint for the Future

The success of these initiatives is just the beginning. With its proven impact on water conservation and sustainable farming, this model has the potential to transform rural communities across India.

At its core, the initiative underscores the power of collaboration—when businesses, local leaders, and communities come together, meaningful change happens. Water conservation isn't just about infrastructure; it's about creating a culture of responsibility, where every drop counts.

With water scarcity emerging as one of the biggest environmental challenges of our time, corporates like PepsiCo India chipping in with long-term, community-driven solutions can make a significant difference. By integrating sustainability into their core operations and working alongside grassroots organizations, businesses can help ensure that rural communities have the resources they need to thrive—not just today, but for generations to come.